

Helicopter Developments

Used increasingly for troop transport, helicopters were also a major part of the air ambulance industry that expanded from small beginnings in the US to become a global phenomena. Research in the UK found that one helicopter could replace 17 ground ambulances. It was calculated that the helicopter had saved its millionth life, in peace and war, toward the end of the 1980s.



△ **Bell 206B JetRanger III 1980**

Origin USA
Engine 450 shp Rolls-Royce 250-C20J turboshaft
Top speed 139 mph (223 km/h)

A development of the 1967 original, the improved JetRanger II was introduced in 1971. By 1977 the first JetRanger IIIs with a larger tail rotor and engine emerged.



◁ **AgustaWestland AW109 1980**

Origin Italy
Engine 2 x 420 shp Rolls-Royce 250-C20 turboshaft
Top speed 193 mph (310 km/h)

First introduced in 1976 several light twin AW109 helicopters were used by Argentina for liaison, transport, and armed escort missions during the Falklands conflict in 1982. Some were later shipped to Britain for display or further operational use.



▷ **Boeing CH-47D Chinook 1982**

Origin USA
Engine 2 x 3,750 shp Honeywell T55-L712 turboshaft
Top speed 183 mph (294 km/h)

The long-lived CH-47 Chinook heavy-lift helicopter entered service with the US Army in 1962. The CH-47D and the CH-47F remain in service today.



◁ **Hughes MD 500E/Hughes 369 1982**

Origin USA
Engine 420 shp Rolls-Royce 250-CBOB
Top speed 175 mph (281 km/h)

The Hughes MD 500E, derived from the Hughes OH-6/500, is a lightweight utility helicopter, used primarily for private and corporate customers. It has also been purchased for US law enforcement operations.



△ **Robinson R22 Beta 1985**

Origin USA
Engine 160 hp Lycoming O-320-B2C piston engine
Top speed 110 mph (177 km/h)

The R22 was introduced in 1979 as a private two-seat light helicopter. It was succeeded by the improved R22B in 1985 with an optional engine speed governor, rotor brake, and auxiliary fuel tank.



▽ **Boeing Apache AH-64 1984**

Origin USA
Engine 2 x 1,690 shp General Electric T700-GE-701 turboshaft
Top speed 235 mph (378 km/h)

This heavy attack helicopter introduced an all-weather, day-and-night capability to the battlefield. It was able to engage heavy armor or troop movements at will and had its own defensive protection.



▷ **Hughes/McDonnell Douglas MD 520N prototype 1989**

Origin USA
Engine 650 shp Rolls Royce 250-C30 turboshaft
Top speed 175 mph (281 km/h)

The MD 520N features a "notar" system. Instead of a tail rotor, this uses airflow from slots in a pressurized tailboom combining with main rotor downwash to counteract torque.

